

Chapter 174-5

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Meanwhile, at the outskirts of the city, Shen Hui and Wu Li stood at the foot of the mountain.

People came and went around them, and quite a few were already heading down the mountain.

People passing by were all talking about the person they had just encountered, saying she was too beautiful.

They also chatted about how this person had made it onto the hot search, climbing the three thousand steps to win back her ex-girlfriend.

Wu Li stood to the side, looking somewhat at a loss. Shen Hui neither spoke nor moved. Ever since Zhao Xuning started kneeling her way up the three thousand steps, she had maintained this posture, completely motionless.

Like a statue.

Finally, Wu Li couldn't hold back. "A-Hui, we're getting engaged next week, right?"

Shen Hui looked at her and pressed her lips together: "Not necessarily?"

Her tone was slow and light, with a hint of hoarseness.

"You're not really going to... because of Zhao Xuning..." Wu Li was stunned and smiled bitterly. "Have you two been connected all along?"¹

Shen Hui shook her head: "We haven't been in contact for a long time."

"Then you?" Wu Li frowned. "You're not really going to believe what she said, are you? I really didn't deceive you, I..."

"I have my own judgment." Shen Hui stood straight with her hands in her pockets. "I don't just believe things because she says a few words."

Wu Li anxiously tried to explain. "We've been together for half a year. You should know what kind of person I am, right?"

"I know," Shen Hui said. "You might be able to deceive me, but Zhao Xuning..."

She paused. "...would never lie about something like this."

Zhao Xuning said Wu Li couldn't be married. She said what Wu Li did wrong was something unforgivable.

Although she didn't specify what exactly it was.

If she didn't have one hundred percent evidence, Zhao Xuning wouldn't slander someone like this.

That was Zhao Xuning.

The stubborn, obstinate, unruly Zhao Xuning who always had high moral standards.

Shen Hui heard people nearby talking about Zhao Xuning making it onto the hot search. Before long, several cars stopped at the foot of the mountain. A large group of bodyguards appeared, and a lavishly dressed woman appeared at the foot of the mountain. Her face bore some resemblance to Zhao Xuning's.

Shen Hui still stood motionless.

Soon, all the hot search topics online were taken down. Then Shen Hui received a call from Shen Fenghe. "Where are you?"

"At the foot of the mountain," Shen Hui said. "I was originally just here to clear my head."

"Come home," Shen Fenghe said. "If you don't want to be entangled with Zhao Xuning anymore."

Shen Hui looked at the endless three thousand steps and smiled bitterly: "It seems I'm destined to be entangled with her."

There was a pause on Shen Fenghe's end, and she didn't speak for a long while.

"Have you thought it through?" Shen Fenghe asked.

Shen Hui exhaled softly, her laugh carrying a choked quality: "Sis, she's climbing the three thousand steps for me."

Shen Fenghe was taken aback: "I know."

"She." Shen Hui paused, a tear sliding down her cheek as she spoke in a choked voice: "She's bowing her head to me."

Shen Fenghe coughed lightly: "And? You're Shen Hui. Shouldn't she bow her head to you? How many times have you swallowed your pride for her?"

Shen Hui's voice was very soft, mingling with the evening spring breeze: "She once said that climbing the three thousand steps with a bow at each step was something she would never do even if she died."

"So?" Shen Fenghe's voice also softened.

Shen Hui thought for a moment: "I'll wait for her at the top of the mountain."

"What about your marriage to Wu Li?" Shen Fenghe asked.

Shen Hui glanced at Wu Li standing beside her: "Cancel it."

Cold and merciless.

As if she wasn't the one who had been dating these past few months.

Indeed, it couldn't really be called dating.

Even though they were at the same hospital, they didn't see each other three times a week. Wu Li still didn't know where her home was. They ate together once a month, and Wu Li had only met her family last week.

Rather than saying they were getting married, it was more like she was truly seeking a way to let herself go.

But she found that neither way was easy.

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1. "藕斷絲連" (the lotus root is severed but the threads remain connected) is a Chinese idiom describing a relationship that has officially ended but emotional ties still remain, like when ex-lovers can't completely let go of each other. ⇐